Salt (table, sea, Himalayan): HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for Salt (table, sea, Himalayan) (Herbs, Spices, Seasonings and Salt), stated as sold. Each analyte carries the strictest applicable government maximum level in the product's native basis, with a disclosed read-across or a mandatory control where no government regulates the exact product.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default; explicit-id lookup; legislated product-form splits preserved; dried-spice basis discipline)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	—	—
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	500	sovereign maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	500	sovereign maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	500	sovereign maximum level
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	100	sovereign maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	n/m	not material in this matrix

Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	—	—
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	n/m	not material in this matrix
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	n/m	not material in this matrix
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	—	—
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	n/m	not material in this matrix

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	—	—
Cadmium (Cd)	500	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	500	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	500	government maximum level
Mercury, total (tHg)	100	government maximum level
Methylmercury (MeHg)	n/m	Methylmercury is the organomercury speciation of mercury and is arithmetically bounded by total mercury (MeHg <= tHg); a mineral salt carries no mercury source and no methylmercury formation pathway, and salt mercury is regulated as total mercury, which the tHg standard caps, bounding any organomercury fraction.
Nickel (Ni)	—	—
Tin (Sn)	n/m	No tin source in a boxed/bagged mineral salt; tin is a tinplate-can migration pathway only.

Aluminium (Al)	n/m	Aluminium in salt derives from permitted anti-caking additives (e.g. sodium aluminosilicate, GRAS in US table salt per 21 CFR 182.2727), not contamination, and is managed by additive law plus intake against the EFSA/JECFA TWI, not by a per-food contaminant maximum level. Matches the existing salt/Al determination in standards-not--material.csv.
Total chromium (Cr)	—	—
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	n/m	Hexavalent chromium is the Cr(VI) speciation of chromium and is bounded by the total-chromium control (Cr-VI <= total Cr), which is screened for salt; no jurisdiction sets a Cr-VI food maximum level. There is no chromium adulteration pathway in a mineral salt (unlike turmeric/chili, salt is not colour-adulterated with lead chromate), so any trace chromium is geologic chromium(III). Rebuttable if a routed source reports hexavalent chromium in salt.

4 | Cite this standard

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STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

COMPETING INTERESTS

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DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/salt. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with

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their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.